User Guide

Etel Ride Platform

Version 1.2 | Etel Group

Prepared for: INSA Cyber-Security Audit Application (Etel Ride scope)

> Version 1.1 adds Section 7 (technology used, key components, system architecture diagram, data flow diagrams and data flow explanation) requested by the INSA reviewer, and is supplied as PDF. Sections 1 to 6 are unchanged. **v1.2 correction:** the driver steps in Section 3.2 and the ride walk-through in Section 7.5.1 now match the app: the driver ends the trip at the drop-off with the "Arrived - Bill Customer" button, and the passenger confirms to complete it.

This guide covers the two roles served directly by Etel Ride: Passenger and Driver, and (briefly) the Equb savings feature available to drivers. A brief note on Admin is included since ride operations are configured there. Etel Delivery's roles (Customer/delivery-ordering, Courier, Service Giver) are a separate service line on the same platform and are out of scope for this document. The Ride and Driver apps are installable as standalone Progressive Web Apps (PWA) from their login page, or distributed as Android apps (Trusted Web Activity).

1. Getting Started (Passenger / Driver)

1.1 Installing the App

Open the relevant app's link in a mobile browser (Chrome recommended) and either accept the "Install App" prompt or use the browser menu's "Add to Home Screen" / "Install" option. Ride and Driver are separate installable apps, each with its own icon.

1.2 Signing In

Two ways to sign in:

- Phone number + password (registered directly in the app)
- "Sign in with EtelID" — using your existing Etel Group identity account

Note: if you have ever signed in as a different role on the same device/browser, that session may carry over — sign out first if you need to switch roles for testing, since the Ride and Driver apps share one browser storage per device.

2. Passenger Guide

A Passenger is a registered account (backend role: customer) using the Ride app to book trips.

2.1 Booking a Ride

1. Open the Ride app and set your pickup and drop-off locations.

2. Choose a vehicle type (bajaj, moto, car, or minibus) and view the fare estimate before booking.

3. Book the ride — the app searches for a nearby available driver.

4. Once a driver accepts, track their live location and chat with them in-app if needed.

5. Once you are aboard and the trip starts, you'll see live status updates. At the end of the trip the driver ends the ride at the drop-off and you confirm the fare and payment.

6. Rate the driver and the ride after completion.

2.2 Safety

A Speak-Up feature (SOS button) is available during any active ride if you feel unsafe — use it to alert support immediately with your live location.

2.3 Other Passenger Features

- Save favorite routes for faster rebooking.
- Schedule a ride in advance.
- Share a live ride-tracking link with someone else.
- View ride history and past ratings.

3. Driver Guide

Becoming a driver requires an onboarding and verification process — you cannot self-register directly as a driver.

3.1 Onboarding

1. Start as a registered account, then begin driver onboarding from the Driver app.

2. Submit your vehicle details (type, make, color, year, plate number), a selfie, and your license photo.

3. Your submission is reviewed and your identity cross-checked (via EtelID) before approval.

4. Once approved, your account is upgraded to Driver status — only then can you go online and accept rides.

Important: you cannot go online, accept ride requests, cash out earnings, or top up your Etel Money wallet until onboarding is fully approved. This is a deliberate safety/fraud-prevention control.

3.2 Accepting & Completing a Ride

1. Go online to start receiving nearby ride requests.

2. Accept a request, then navigate to the passenger's pickup location.

3. Start the ride once the passenger is aboard. If you need to wait during the trip, use the wait control; billable waiting time is capped.

4. Navigate to the drop-off location.

5. At the drop-off, tap "Arrived - Bill Customer". The passenger sees the fare and confirms, and the ride is then completed and your earnings are updated. If the passenger does not confirm, cash rides are completed automatically after a timeout (30 minutes by default); wallet rides are referred to support.

3.3 Earnings & Wallet

- View your earnings and KPI summary at any time.
- Cash out earnings directly from the app.
- Top up your internal Etel Money wallet: pay via Etel Pay separately, then submit the transaction reference and a receipt photo in the app. Your top-up is verified automatically, then requires a separate admin approval before the balance is credited to your account — this can take some time, it is not instant.

3.4 Compliance & Vehicle Updates

- Submit compliance documents (insurance, technical inspection, road fund) with their expiry dates — these require admin approval.
- If your vehicle details change after onboarding (new plate, different vehicle), submit a vehicle-change request — this also requires admin approval before it takes effect anywhere (map, ride previews, profile).

3.5 Safety & Support

- Use the SOS button during an active ride if you feel unsafe.

- Report ride issues from the app.
- Check driver announcements for platform news.
- Log fuel expenses for your own record-keeping.
- Join an Equb (rotating savings) group — see Section 5.

4. Admin Guide (Ride-relevant subset)

Admin accounts configure and support the Ride service through the shared Admin app. Access to each area is governed by capability-based permissions — not every admin account can see or do everything.

Area	What you can do there
Rides	View and manage active/past rides, resolve ride issues, respond to SOS alerts
Pricing	Configure ride fare rules and surge settings
Support	Handle driver/passenger issue tickets, review driver compliance documents and vehicle-change requests
Releases	Manage staged rollouts for the Ride and Driver apps (stable/canary channels)
Equb	Manage rotating-savings groups and packages

The Admin app also configures Etel Delivery operations (orders, couriers, service givers, delivery pricing) and platform-wide functions unrelated to either service line (Roles, Finance & Planning, Danger Zone, internal Documents) — these are out of scope for this document.

5. Equb (Rotating Savings) Guide

Equb is a traditional Ethiopian rotating-savings benefit offered to Drivers (also available to Etel Delivery's Couriers, out of scope here).

1. Browse available Equb groups and their contribution packages.

2. Join a group and select a package.

3. Make your contributions each round as tracked in the app.

4. Payouts rotate among group members according to the group's schedule — track your position and payout history in the app.

Admins manage group creation, package definitions, participant access, and can force-process a round if needed from the Admin app's Equb section.

6. Getting Help

- Ride and order issues can be reported directly from the relevant ride screen.
- For account or payment problems not resolved in-app, contact Etel Group support through your organization's usual support channel.

7. How the System Works (Overview for Users)

This section was added in version 1.1 at the INSA reviewer's request. It explains, in plain language, the technology behind the Ride and Driver apps, the main components you interact with, how the system is put together, and how your data moves through it. Technical detail is in the companion SDD and Security Documentation.

7.1 Technology used

What you use	Technology	What it means for you
Ride app and Driver app	Progressive Web Apps (PWA), installable on Android as an app (Trusted Web Activity)	Install from the browser; no app-store download is needed; updates arrive automatically
Maps and location	Google Maps, browser location (GPS)	Shows pickup, drop-off, route and the driver's live position; the app asks your permission to use location
Server	PHP 8.1 on secure web hosting (HTTPS)	All requests are encrypted in transit
Database	MySQL	Stores accounts, rides, fares and driver records
Sign-in	Phone + password, or Sign in with EtelID; signed login token valid for up to 7 days	Signing out ends your session on the server immediately
Live updates	Server-Sent Events	Ride status and driver position update on screen without refreshing
Notifications and alerts	Web Push; Telegram alerts to staff	Ride notifications to you; SOS and issue alerts reach support staff
Payments	Etel Pay (Etel Money top-ups)	Top-up references are checked with Etel Pay before an admin approves them
Offline use	Service worker cache	If the connection drops, the app shows an offline page instead of failing blank

7.2 Key components

Component	What it does for you	Who uses it
Ride app	Book a ride, see the fare estimate, track the driver, chat, use SOS, rate the trip, save routes, schedule and share rides	Passenger
Driver app	Onboarding, go online, accept and run rides, view earnings, cash out, top up Etel Money, upload compliance documents, Equb	Driver
Admin app	Fare and pricing rules, driver and vehicle-change approval, ride and SOS support, release management, Equb administration	Admin staff
Ride server (single gateway)	Checks who you are and what you may do for every request, then passes it to the right function	All users (behind the scenes)
Fare and matching engine	Calculates the fare on the server and finds nearby drivers	All users (behind the scenes)
Etel Group identity (EtelID)	Sign in with EtelID and driver identity cross-check	Passenger, Driver
Etel Pay	Verifies the payment reference you submit for an Etel Money top-up	Driver
Google Maps	Map display, place search, address lookup	Passenger, Driver
Notifications and alerts	Push notifications to you; Telegram and push alerts to support staff	All users

7.3 System architecture diagram

The apps on your phone (client tier) talk over a secure connection to one Ride server (application tier). The server checks every request, reads and writes the database and file storage (data tier), and calls outside services such as EtelID, Etel Pay, Google Maps and notification services.

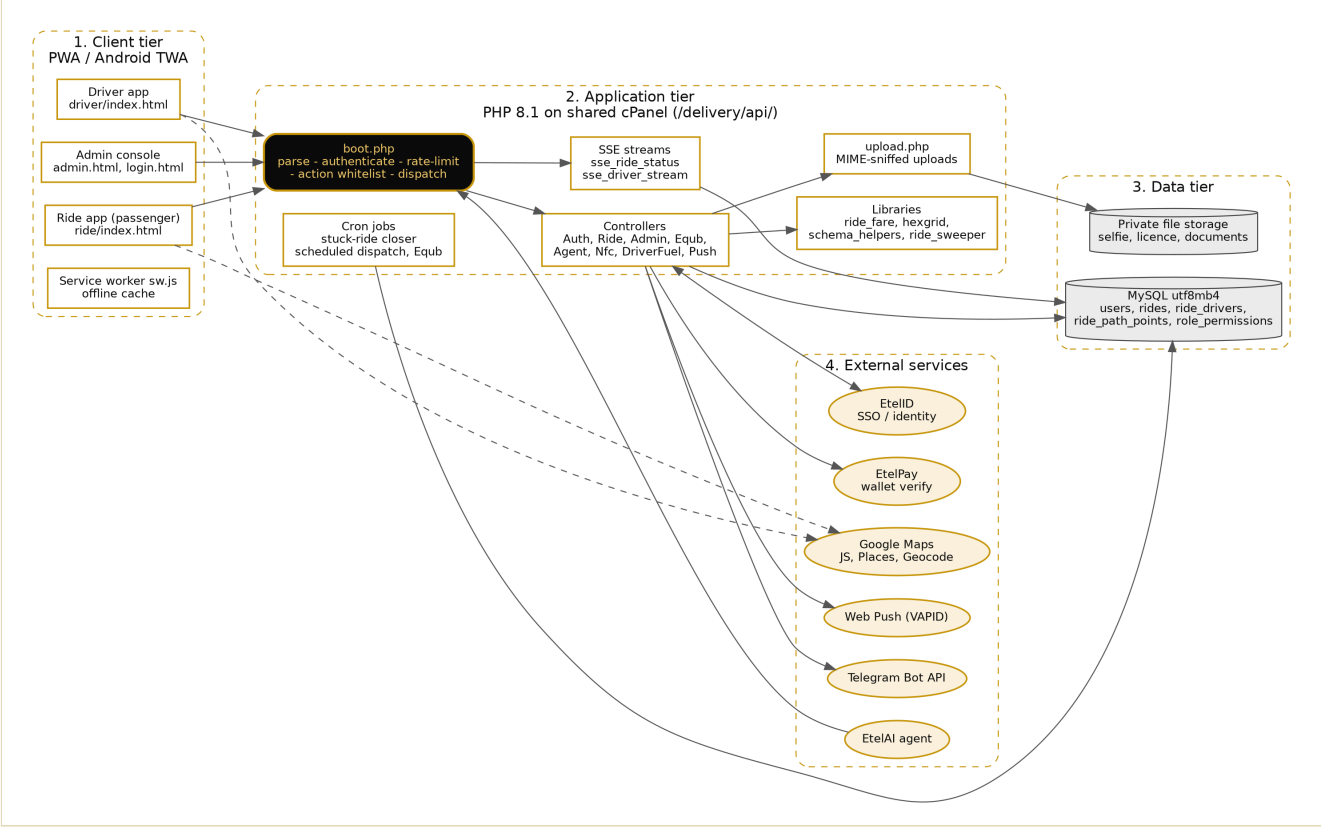


Figure 1 - Etel Ride system architecture

7.4 Data flow diagrams

7.4.1 Level 0 - context diagram

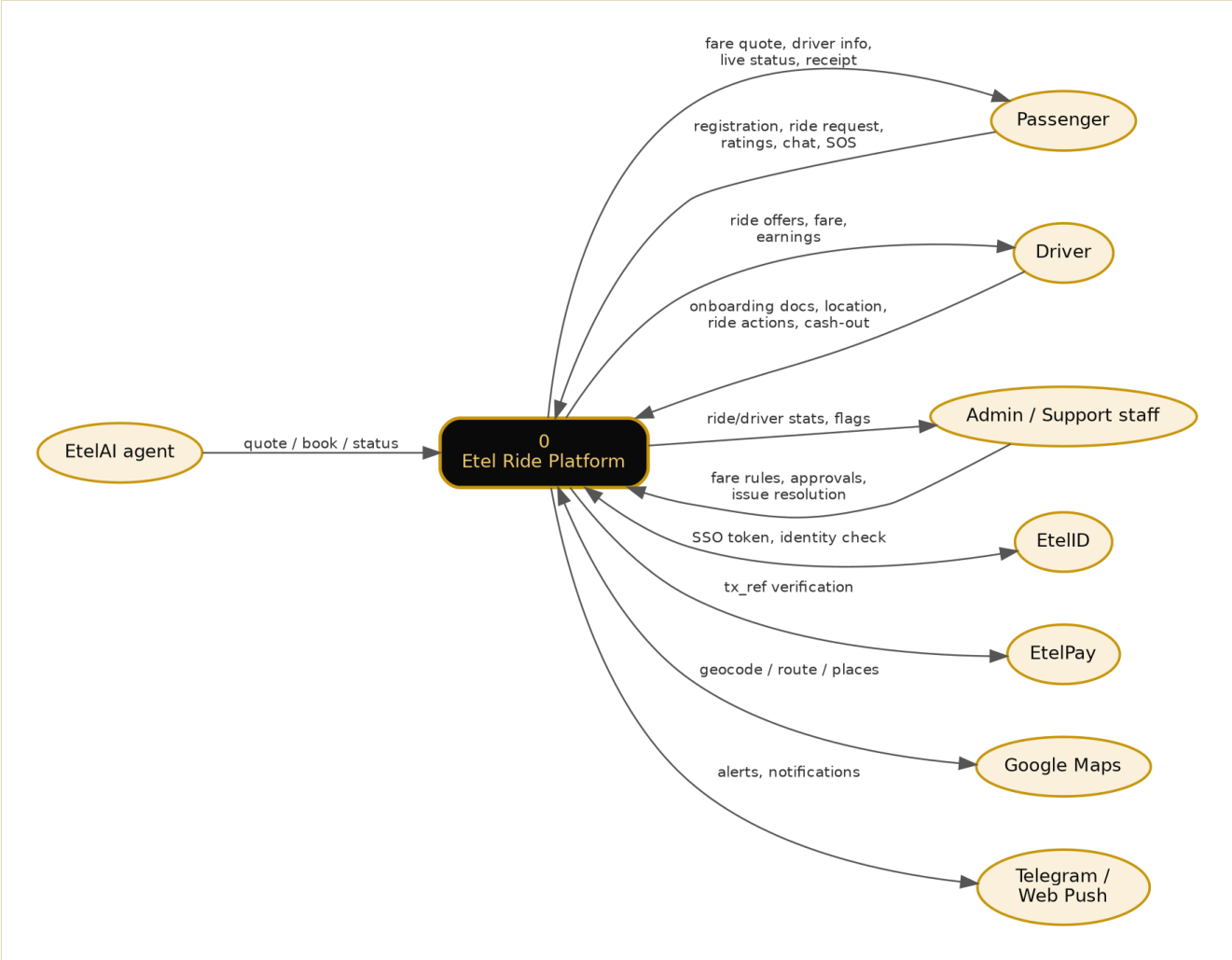


Figure 2 - Level 0 DFD: what flows between Etel Ride and the people and systems around it

7.4.2 Level 1 - process decomposition

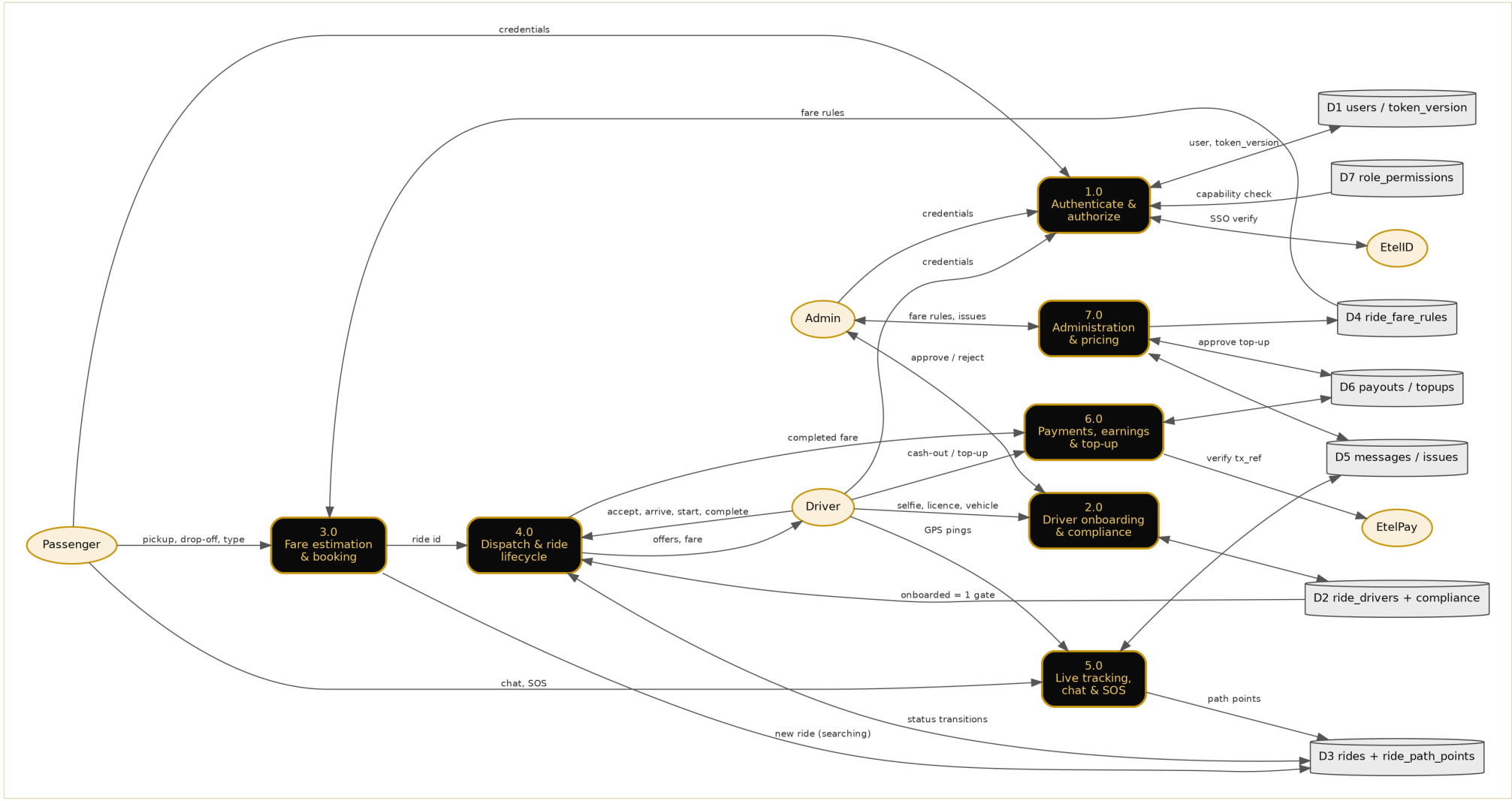


Figure 3 - Level 1 DFD: the seven main processes and the data they use

7.5 Data flow explanation

The diagrams read as follows: rectangles with gold borders are processes (what the system does), cylinders are stored data, and ovals are people or outside systems.

Your data	Where it goes	How it is protected
Phone number and password	Ride server, then the user database	Sent over HTTPS; password stored only as a salted hash; login attempts are limited
Pickup and drop-off	Ride server, which calculates the fare using the admin-set rules and stores the ride	The fare is calculated by the server, not the phone, so it cannot be altered from the app
Your live location (while on a ride)	Ride server, stored as the ride's route, shown only to you and the driver/passenger on that ride	Only the two people on the ride can see the live position
Chat messages, ratings, SOS and issues	Ride server and database; SOS and issues also alert support staff	In-ride chat is limited to the two people on the ride
Driver selfie, licence and documents	Ride server, stored under system-generated file names	Checked for valid image type and size; reviewed by admin; identity cross-checked with EtelID
Top-up reference and receipt	Ride server, which checks it with Etel Pay; then an admin approval	Balance only changes after both the Etel Pay check and the admin approval

7.5.1 What happens during a ride

1. **Sign in (process 1.0).** You log in; the server checks your details and gives your phone a signed token. Each later request carries that token.
2. **Estimate and book (3.0).** You send your pickup, drop-off and vehicle type. The server works out the fare from the admin-configured rules and creates the ride as "searching".
3. **Match and accept (4.0).** Nearby online drivers receive the request. Only a fully onboarded driver can accept, and only one driver can take the ride.
4. **Ride (4.0 and 5.0).** The driver starts the trip once you are aboard. The driver's phone sends location points; you see them live. Chat and SOS are available throughout.
5. **Complete and pay (6.0).** At the drop-off the driver ends the trip and the fare breakdown is saved. You confirm the fare and payment, the ride is completed and driver earnings are updated, and you can then rate the ride.
6. **Support and admin (7.0).** If anything goes wrong, you report an issue or use SOS; support staff in the Admin app can see and resolve it.